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Subject Code: DMM-01
Paper ID: 13111

GNIOT Institute of Management Studies – PGDM (Batch 2022-24)
(TRIMESTER – III) END TERM EXAMINATION, APRIL - 2023
SALES, DISTRIBUTION & RETAIL MANAGEMENT

[Time: 2 Hours 30 Minutes]

[Maximum Marks: 100]

INSTRUCTIONS:

- (i) There are **THREE** sections in this question paper.
- (ii) Attempt questions from each section as per the directions.
- (iii) Make suitable assumptions wherever necessary.

SECTION-A**(Short Answer Type Questions, do not exceed 100 words)****Q.1. Write short notes on the following:****(10×3=30)**

- (a) What do you mean by sales Budget?
- (b) Explain the difference between trial close and close?
- (c) What is sales territory?
- (d) How is sales strategy different from marketing strategy?
- (e) “If you pay a salesperson enough, you will have a well motivated salesperson” Comment?
- (f) What is prospecting?
- (g) Discuss the role of distribution management in the marketing mix?
- (h) Discuss contractual VMS?
- (i) Enumerate the various retail formats in India?
- (j) What are the major areas of channel conflicts?

SECTION-B**(Long Answer Type Questions)****Attempt all questions of the following:****(4×10=40)****Q.2. (a) What are the responsibilities of a competent sales manager?****OR**

- (b) Suppose a customer has approached a salesperson in an electronics store to seek advice for which laptop to buy. Using the personal selling process, identify the sales techniques you would employ to close a sale.

Q.3. (a) Elaborate on channel conflict and suggest ways to counter them.**OR**

- (b) Discuss the trends in wholesaling.

Q.4. (a) Define the process of retail planning with respect to an electronics store.**OR**

- (b) Write short notes on:

- (i) Logistics V/S Supply Chain Management
- (ii) Evolution of ERP

Q.5. (a) Distinguish between horizontal and vertical marketing systems

OR

(b) What strategies can you adopt as a retail manager of a newly opened apparel store to enhance sales and increase footfall in your store?

SECTION-C

Q.6. Attempt all parts of the following:

(2×15=30)

In this digital era, there is still the existence of one category of promotion that truly stands out – Word of Mouth! And Pulse candy has proved that no form of marketing beats product marketing, and this candy has surpassed all competition and beaten all the records by crossing the 100-crore mark in just 8 months after its launch! This figure equals the record for heavily advertised Cole Zero, Coca Cola's diet drink!

In low price high volume, there is always a need of developing a sale story for the salesman, to enable them to place the product at the outlet, and for the retailer to push the product trial to the customers.

Once the trials made started gaining traction, the product strength took it forward. Word of mouth started catching up as most people started referring the candies to their friends and colleagues. At some places it became a mouth freshener of sort after lunch at others it was a regular get together Candy among friends in a college class. The word had set in.

The awesome part of its success story is that Pulse has hardly spent a single penny on any marketing. The whole lift in demand is due to word of mouth publicity. Demand is much more than the supply and currently the company can meet only 60-70% of the demand, said Shashank Surana, vice-president, DS Group.

Indian customers usually buys candy in single pieces, but in the case of pulse candy, consumers are buying in bulk—five to 10 in one go. At present, DS Group produces 300-400 tonnes of Pulse candy each month. Once Pulse reaches most top towns, DS Group plans to start promotions and a brand-building exercise.

With the rising demand of Pulse it started selling at a premium, it had to be supported well through the distribution. More than 80% market coverage, frequent refillment, and overall tight distribution norms helped Pulse be available at every nook and corner of the city. Launch in Rajasthan and Gujarat was followed up by launch in UP & Delhi. At 2015 end, a new Guava flavor of Pulse candy was launched in the market. The company crossed 100 Crore mark soon.

With nearly no advertising and minimal merchandising, Pulse is a story of product being the ultimate winner. The best strategy for DS group is still to develop a product that speaks for itself, maybe it Pass Pass or Catch mineral water. The journey of Pulse has just begun and it rightly aims to be among the top 3 candies in India.

6(a) In the case of products like Pulse sales team doesn't sell rather look at the transactional part. Give your opinion about the statement.

6(b) What possible challenges DS group might have faced in terms of sales and distribution of Pulse. Suggest measures to deal with the challenges.